

Chapter 7-1

After saying this, Liang Shi awkwardly touched the tip of her nose and silently apologized to Xu Qingya in her heart.

She didn't want to deceive Xu Qingzhu.

Especially when facing those eyes, lying would make her feel guilty.

Cheng Ran waved at Xu Qingzhu from behind Liang Shi, "Long time no see, Miss Xu."

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu didn't make Liang Shi lose face either, nodding slightly at her with a weak voice, "Hello."

Hearing this, Cheng Ran smiled even more brightly, stepping forward in her high heels, but was stopped by Liang Shi grabbing her arm as she passed by.

Cheng Ran frowned, saying in a low voice: "Isn't this being too protective? I can't even go forward to greet her? Liang Shi, that's enough."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her voice heavy, "Come with me."

She turned back to look at Xu Qingzhu, "You go back to the ward first. I'll come find you after I say a few words to Cheng Ran."

"It's fine." Xu Qingzhu's face was pale, her figure slender, looking malnourished. Standing at the door, she was like a painting of absolute independence, "Just tell me where Yaya is."

"Wait a moment." Liang Shi looked at her very sincerely, "I'll just say a few words to her, then accompany you to find Yaya, okay?"

"You don't need to accompany me." Xu Qingzhu refused, "I can go find her myself."

Liang Shi frowned slightly, "I'll accompany you."

"No need." Xu Qingzhu continued to refuse.

She didn't believe that Liang Shi could completely change and become a different person within a day.

She was more inclined to believe that Liang Shi's current behavior had some ulterior motive.

As for what that motive was, she hadn't figured it out yet.

However, their relationship wasn't good enough for this level of concern.

It was just a coincidence that when Xu Qingzhu went to the bathroom, she heard her making a phone call in the hallway, so she called both her and Xu Qingya and found both lines were busy, leading to this speculation.

She hadn't even figured out why Xu Qingya would contact Liang Shi.

When did Xu Qingya and Liang Shi become so familiar?

After Xu Qingzhu finished speaking, she didn't continue to entangle with her. She first sent a message to Zhao Xuning, saying she planned to leave the ward for a while and asking her to come give her an injection of inhibitor¹.

An Omega's scent would disperse outside just after passing her heat period, and it would be very dangerous if smelled by an Alpha with strong pheromones. Xu Qingzhu had just gone through such a mentally and physically exhausting night and didn't want to experience a second time.

So it was better to be cautious.

After receiving the message, Zhao Xuning only replied with "okay."

Meanwhile, in the hallway, Liang Shi pulled Cheng Ran to one side.

Cheng Ran crossed her arms with a disdainful expression, "Liang Shi, you just now really..."

She clicked her tongue, speaking carelessly, "Don't tell me you've really fallen for this Omega."

"Cheng Ran." Liang Shi was thinking about what words to use to remind Cheng Ran to maintain normal social distance.

In that world, she had lived for twenty-five years.

She had spent a long time alone, so she could maintain good distance between people.

Never too close, never too distant.

She had never even had a falling out with friends.

But she and Cheng Ran were really not suitable to be friends.

The original body became friends with Cheng Ran because they could mess around together, but Liang Shi had always despised such behavior.

She preferred the state of one life, one world, one pair.

Finding a girl she liked, whether they got married or not, working hard during work hours, occasionally slacking off to send the other person a message when tired.

After work, the two would go watch a movie together, or cook and watch dramas at home, doing intimate things.

She didn't mind bringing the other person into her world, and she also hoped to become part of the other person's life.

However, in her original world, this idea was just wishful thinking.

Everyone disapproved of her sexual orientation.

She was also afraid of hurting other girls because of her profession, so she had never been in a relationship.

Even when she encountered girls she had a slight crush on, she only dared to watch from afar.

She never thought about obtaining them.

But now she was essentially living a second life, and she wanted to be herself.

Before, she had too heavy moral shackles, living too tiredly for livelihood and for others.

Now, she wanted to live more easily.

Making friends who were easy to get along with, and falling in love with someone she liked.

But how to deal with the original body's problems was a big trouble.

After thinking about it, she could only say straightforwardly: "I think we're not suitable to be friends."

Cheng Ran was stunned, "Huh?"

Liang Shi said very seriously: "I won't participate in those parties and gatherings with you anymore. Life should have infinite possibilities, not waste time on those meaningless things that squander time."

Cheng Ran was confused for a few seconds, then laughed angrily, "Liang Shi, are you crazy? What are you talking about? Did Xu Qingzhu feed you some kind of love potion?"

"It has nothing to do with Xu Qingzhu." Liang Shi said: "I figured it out myself. I want to start over and be my true self."

These words were both for the original Liang Shi and for the current Liang Shi.

Cheng Ran's brows furrowed like a small mountain, "Are you saying you want to break off our friendship?"

"You could understand it that way." Liang Shi said firmly.

"Damn." Cheng Ran was so angry she cursed, "What the f***."

She swung her fist.

Liang Shi's eyes narrowed slightly. She could have easily dodged, but she hesitated for a moment and took the hit.

An Alpha's strength was considerable, and the punch made her stagger.

Liang Shi stepped back half a step, "That's it then. I'm leaving first."

"F***." Cheng Ran shouted behind her, "Liang Shi, you're f***ing crazy."

Liang Shi walked away determinedly, without looking back.

Footnotes: ¹ Inhibitor: In ABO dynamics, a medication that suppresses an Omega's scent/pheromones to prevent unwanted attention from Alphas

Chapter 7-2

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Actually, Liang Shi had many ways to break off with Cheng Ran gracefully.

She could avoid meeting when Cheng Ran looked for her, or find some trivial matter to have a big fight with Cheng Ran and end things there.

But Liang Shi chose the most straightforward method.

She didn't want to waste too much time on this kind of interpersonal relationship.

Thinking pessimistically, if she couldn't obtain 80 luck points within three months, these would be the last three months of her life. How much time did she have to maneuver around with them?

It was too exhausting.

Better to keep it simple.

She stood at the door of Xu Qingzhu's hospital room, extending the back of her hand to wipe the corner of her mouth, bloodstains falling onto her hand.

She frowned slightly, not wanting Xu Qingzhu to see this.

But this scene fell into Zhao Xuning's eyes.

Zhao Xuning spoke coldly, "Move aside."

Liang Shi stepped aside, making way for her.

Zhao Xuning was usually a woman of few words, but as she passed by Liang Shi's side, she couldn't help but ask curiously, "Did you fight with Cheng Ran?"

Liang Shi wearily responded with a "mm."

Zhao Xuning curved the corner of her mouth in a smile that wasn't quite a smile, carrying a hint of mockery. "How rare."

After saying this, she entered the hospital room.

Xu Qingzhu had already changed her clothes. These were new clothes that Bai Weiwei had brought when she came to visit her.

A bright yellow fitted knee-length dress, with her slender arms and beautiful collarbones exposed. She was already thin, and wearing this dress made her waist look impossibly narrow.

Particularly eye-catching.

If placed in Liang Shi's original world, Xu Qingzhu would definitely become a top star in the entertainment industry, leaving everyone in the dust in annual goddess polls.

The needle pierced into Xu Qingzhu's slender, pale arm, her blood vessels visible under the sunlight.

This made Liang Shi's heart tighten.

Such an arm didn't seem suitable for injections.

It looked quite shocking.

So Liang Shi looked away.

After Zhao Xuning finished giving Xu Qingzhu the inhibitor injection, she asked, "How long will you be out?"

"Probably half a day." Xu Qingzhu said: "I'll be back in the evening."

"What are you going to do? Is it convenient to say?" Zhao Xuning asked.

"My dad tore up Yaya's idol posters and threw away her merchandise¹, so she ran away from home." Xu Qingzhu stood up, "I'm leaving first. Don't tell Weiwei about this."

If Weiwei knew she had left the hospital without permission because of her sister's matter, she would definitely be unhappy.

"Got it." Zhao Xuning asked: "Are you going with her?"

Her gaze was directed at Liang Shi.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment, then nodded lightly, "She knows where Yaya is."

In fact, only she knew.

"Then be careful on the road." Zhao Xuning said, "Call me if anything happens."

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Coming out of the hospital room, they took the elevator straight down to the underground parking garage.

After Liang Shi was hospitalized, the butler had already driven her car over.

In the black and white underground parking garage, that gaudy green car was extremely conspicuous.

Although Liang Shi really didn't want to admit it, she had no choice but to bring Xu Qingzhu to that car.

She pressed the unlock button again, and the car's front and rear lights lit up.

Liang Shi: "....."

Just how many aesthetic surprises did the original body have that she didn't know about?

She first opened the passenger door, and under Xu Qingzhu's slightly disdainful gaze, she said with feigned composure: "Get in."

After Xu Qingzhu got in the car, she got in herself.

But she noticed that Xu Qingzhu was looking at her very seriously.

Those eyes carried scrutiny and curiosity. When the car drove out of the parking garage, she suddenly spoke: "Why did you fight with Cheng Ran?"

"Huh?" At the moment the car started, the engine sound was too loud, and Liang Shi didn't hear clearly, "What did you say?"

"Nothing." Xu Qingzhu dropped the topic, sitting in the passenger seat with her eyes closed, pretending to rest.

She maintained a very cold demeanor throughout.

When the car was driving smoothly, Liang Shi discussed with her, "Could you not appear first when we get there?"

"What do you mean?" Xu Qingzhu opened her eyes, looking at her coldly.

"I promised your sister not to tell you." Liang Shi said: "But I think I can't lie to you."

"This isn't the first time you've lied to me." Xu Qingzhu said coldly.

"But I'm not lying to you this time." Liang Shi explained, "Your sister contacted me first, she must have something inconvenient to tell you, so let me go first, feel out what she has to say, then tell you everything, okay?"

"What if I say no?" Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "....."

She pulled the car over to the side of the road, "Then I have no way to take you there."

Xu Qingzhu laughed coldly, "Finally showing your true colors."

"No." Liang Shi sighed helplessly, "I said I wouldn't hurt you, so correspondingly, I won't lie to you either. Your sister is currently fighting with your parents and has run away from home, and she hasn't called you, she must still be angry and emotional. If you appear in front of her now, what if she has an extreme reaction?"

"Our family affairs don't need Miss Liang to worry about." Xu Qingzhu drew a clear line with her, directly calling her Miss Liang.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, her voice carrying a sense of helplessness, "I'm afraid she might say something hurtful that would make you sad."

Xu Qingzhu looked at her, somewhat incredulous.

Was this really Liang Shi?

Liang Shi's hand gently rested on her shoulder, her gaze sincere and warm, "Xu Qingzhu, trust me once, okay?"

Liang Shi without makeup had very beautiful eyes, with warmth enough to melt people. Being stared at so intensely by her, Xu Qingzhu's heart actually skipped a beat.

But quickly, she looked away.

Liang Shi's tone became even more sincere, even carrying a hint of pleading humility.

Listening carefully, it even sounded like acting spoiled, "This is the last time, okay?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded lightly.

She thought, she would try trusting Liang Shi one last time.

Footnotes: ¹ Merchandise: Refers to collectible items related to idols/celebrities, commonly called "周邊" (zhōubiān) in Chinese, including posters, photo cards, accessories, etc.